

# Trust and Transparency in Generative AI

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Research Presentation

*Comparing User Perceptions of  
Commercial and Institutional  
Platforms*

Presented by :  
**Sasha Watanabe & Sara Waters**



Image: University of Florida

# Motivation

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- Rapid growth of generative AI in higher education
- University of Florida launched NaviGator Chat (2024) as a “reliable, private, and safe” institutional platform
- However, transparency about NaviGator Chat’s data retention, access, and internal use is limited
- Little understanding of user trust, privacy perception, or awareness
- Students are an at-risk population due to their limited knowledge of or training in online privacy practices and with NaviGator Chat being promoted primarily for internal use

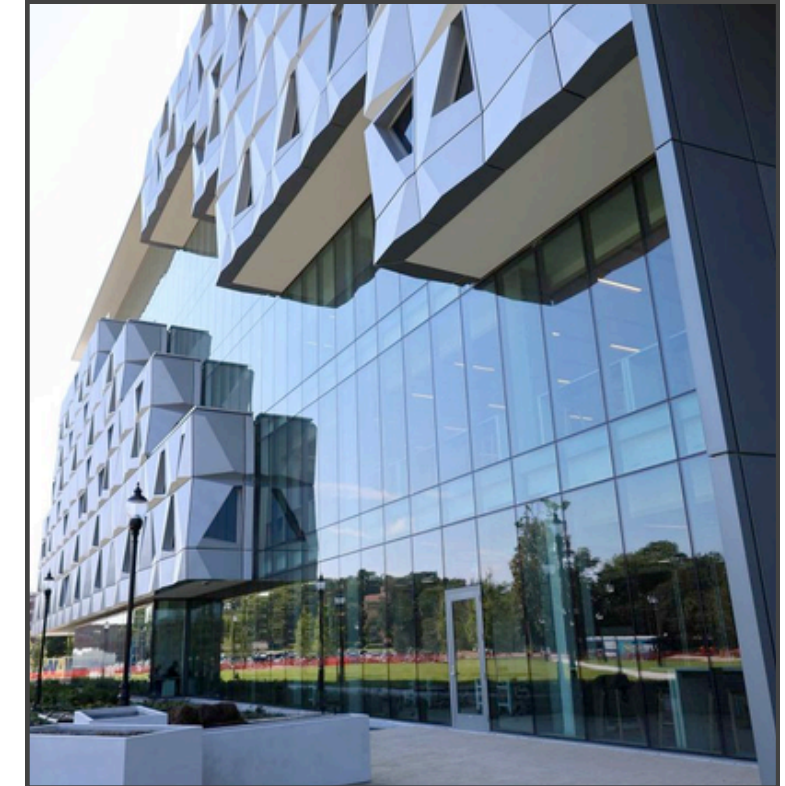


Image: University of Florida

# Problem Statement

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The primary objective of this project is to investigate the attitudes of UF students, faculty, and staff toward generative AI tools, how these attitudes are formed, and how they impact the use of generative AI platforms.

## 01. Usage

*How extensively do UF students, faculty, and staff use generative AI?*

## 02. Trust

*How do they perceive privacy and trust in commercial versus institutional platforms?*

## 03. Privacy

*What do they understand about how generative AI platforms handle data and privacy?*

## 04. Risk

*What are the risks that arise from misconceptions and lack of transparency?*



Image: University of Florida

# Methodology

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- Mixed-methods design:
  - Survey
  - Semi-structured interviews
  - Literature and policy review
- Descriptive analysis and thematic coding
- Recruitment challenges with low staff and faculty responses

## Survey

*53 respondents*

Qualtrics survey distributed to University of Florida students, faculty, and staff

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## Semi-structured Interviews

*3 interviewees*

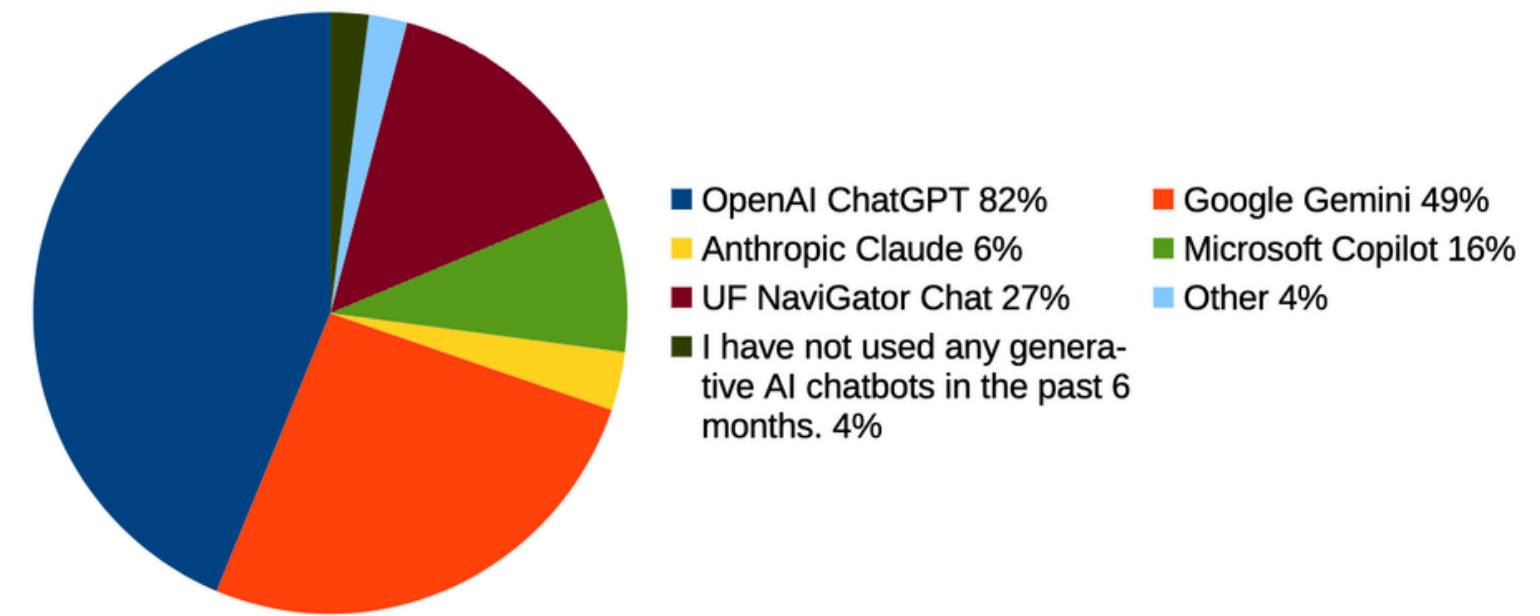
Two students and one staff member interviewed about their privacy reasoning and generative AI usage behaviors



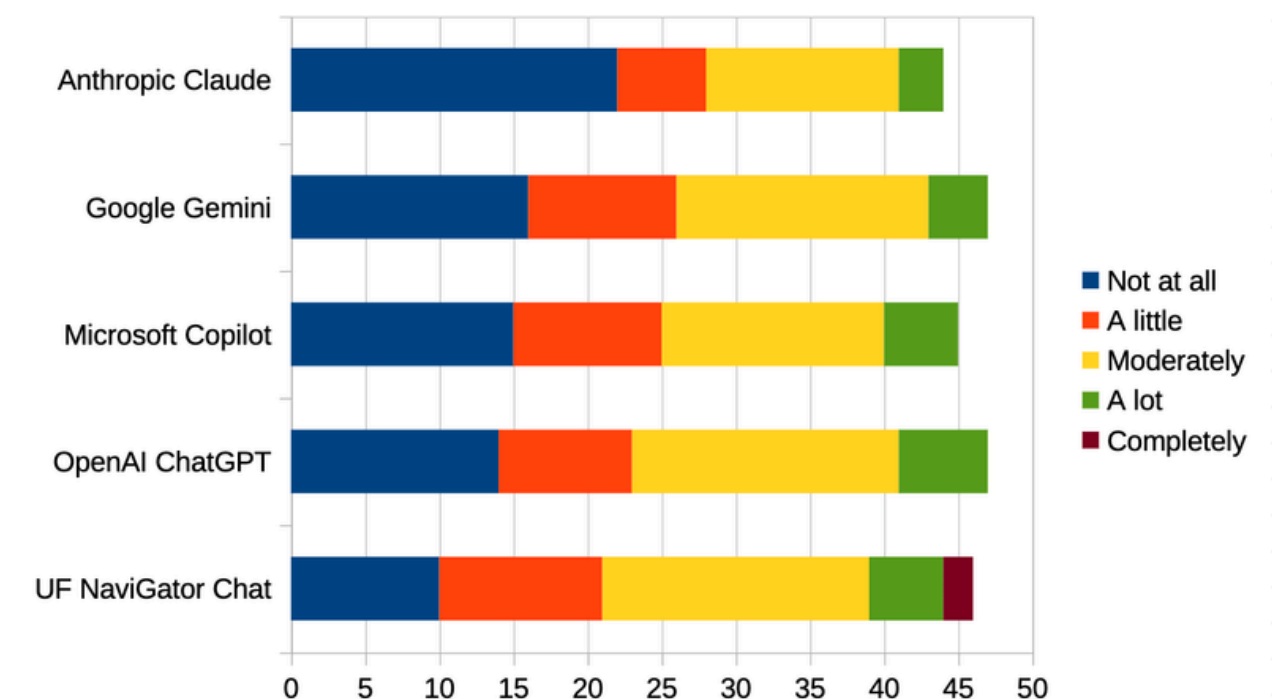
# Results

- **71% (36) of respondents use some generative AI tool** but all respondents were at least “slightly familiar” with these systems
- Only **31% of respondents use NaviGator Chat**
- Out of the 16 respondents who use NaviGator Chat, the use cases are primarily research, academic, or professional work
- **38% of respondents never pay attention** to NaviGator Chat **data labels** and 31% only sometimes
- Most common influences in generative AI platforms are:
  - Public reputation (55%)
  - Accurate and unbiased output (53%)
  - Recommendation from family, friends, peers (49%)
  - Requirement for a class or by UF (45%)

Which generative AI platforms have you used in the past 6 months?  
(Select all that apply)



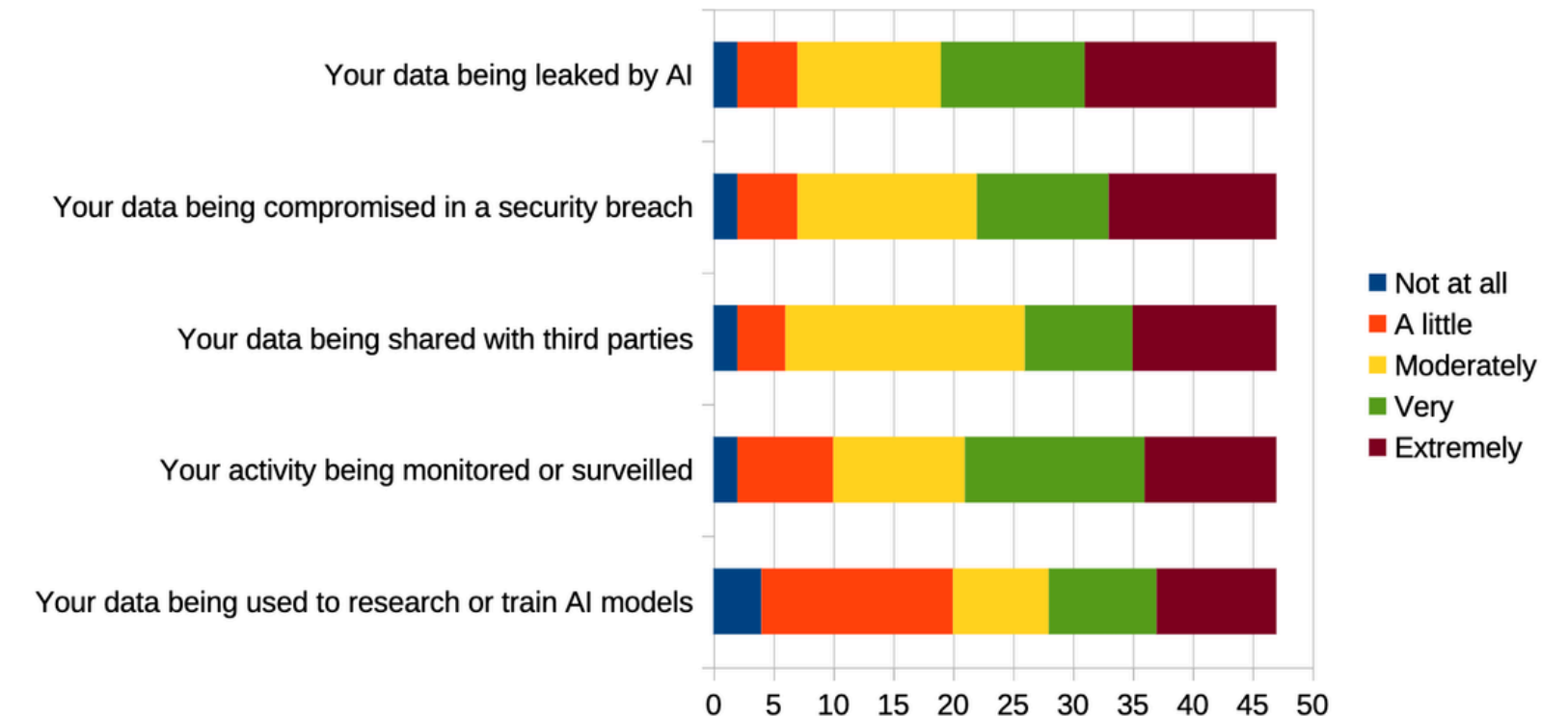
How much do you trust the following platforms to handle your data responsibly?



# Results

- **53% of respondents** believe that **NaviGator Chat provides the same level of privacy protection** as commercial platforms with 38% believing it is somewhat or significantly better
- **Privacy concerns specific to NaviGator Chat** included:
  - Activity monitoring
  - Data used for training
  - General lack of understanding of how the platform works
- Respondents were generally only more comfortable sharing professional work with NaviGator Chat and **less comfortable sharing personal and academic work than with commercial platforms**

How concerned are you about the following privacy issues when using generative AI?



*"[Privacy is] subjective thing to change ... each person can consider something private, and someone else wouldn't." - P1 (Student)*

*"[Students] only care if someone they don't like has access to their data. People only care what affects them directly." - P2 (Staff)*

*"No one reads the fine print, because no one's expected to, it's socially acceptable not to. And nor does anyone really want to ... we're so desensitized to giving up personal information." - P3 (Student)*

# Takeaways

- University of Florida students, faculty, and staff use generative AI fairly extensively
- Generative AI usage and trust is motivated by peers and generally based on assumptions
- Privacy concerns include security and monitoring
- Users try to manage privacy but are limited by their understanding

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## Recommendations

**01.**

Publish accessible data-handling policies for NaviGator Chat and promote safety features

**02.**

Provide privacy literacy and generative AI courses or support in curriculum and orientation

**03.**

Customize outreach to students, faculty, and staff and encourage discussion about safety and privacy